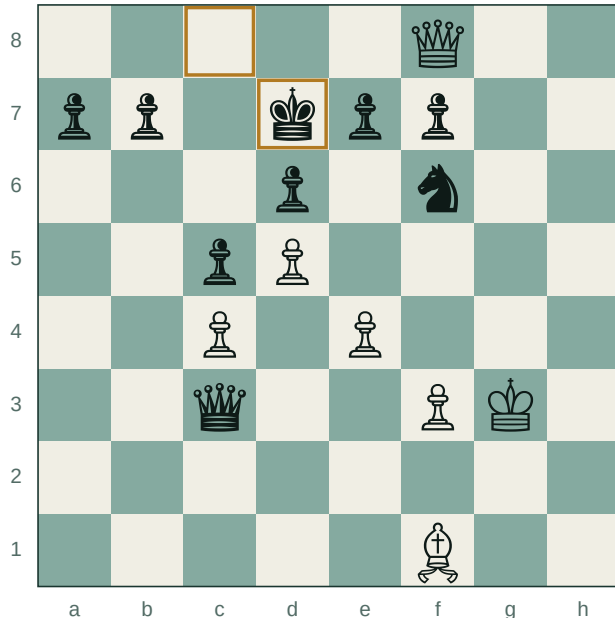


Deflection tactics: White, move 34

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 33...Kd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34. Bh3+ Kc7 35. Qxe7+

34.Bh3+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **34...Kc7**.

35.Qxe7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From e7 it attacks king on c7 and knight on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -2 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on d7. Geometrically undefended: queen on c3. Check for tactical protection.